

Lab 2: Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

Scenario #46 – Remote Team Time-Tracking & Project Approver | Jira project: Software Engineering Lab 2 (SEL2) | Board: SEL2 board (Scrum)

Actors: Remote Developer, Engineering Manager | Site: louisalan21092005.atlassian.net

Epics	User stories	Total points	Sprints run	Points delivered
5	15	65	2 (both completed)	58 of 65 (89%)

1. Epics (derived from Lab 1 functional requirements)

Key	Epic	Description	Stories	Points
SEL2-1	Time Tracking & Logging	Let developers log hours against project tasks with valid, editable entries.	3	10
SEL2-2	Jira Ticket Integration	Link time entries to Jira tickets, sync ticket data and expose project budget burn.	3	21
SEL2-3	Timesheet Submission & Approval	Submit timesheets and let managers review, approve or reject them.	3	13
SEL2-4	Timesheet History & Reporting	History, team hours reporting and exports for developers and managers.	3	10
SEL2-5	Notifications & Reminders	Deadline reminders, approval notifications and budget alerts.	3	11

2. Product backlog – user stories, priority and story points

Stories follow the *As a [role], I want [goal], so that [benefit]* format. Points use the Fibonacci scale (1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13). Rows are grouped by epic and ordered by priority within the backlog.

Key	Epic	User story	Priority	Pts	Sprint	Status
SEL2-6	SEL2-1	Story 1.1: Log Time Against Project Tasks	High	5	Sprint 1	Done
SEL2-7	SEL2-1	Story 1.2: Prevent Over-24-Hour Daily Entries	High	3	Sprint 1	Done
SEL2-8	SEL2-1	Story 1.3: Edit or Delete Draft Time Entries	Medium	2	Sprint 1	Done
SEL2-9	SEL2-2	Story 2.1: Link Time Entries to Jira Tickets	High	5	Sprint 1	Done
SEL2-10	SEL2-2	Story 2.2: Sync Jira Ticket Status and Details	Medium	8	Sprint 2	Done
SEL2-11	SEL2-2	Story 2.3: View Project Budget Burn Rate	High	8	Sprint 2	Done
SEL2-12	SEL2-3	Story 3.1: Submit Timesheet for Approval	High	3	Sprint 1	Done
SEL2-13	SEL2-3	Story 3.2: Review Pending Timesheets	High	5	Sprint 1	Done
SEL2-14	SEL2-3	Story 3.3: Approve or Reject Timesheet with Comments	High	5	Sprint 1	Done
SEL2-15	SEL2-4	Story 4.1: View Personal Timesheet History	Medium	3	Sprint 2	Done
SEL2-16	SEL2-4	Story 4.2: Team Hours Report for Manager	Medium	5	Sprint 2	Done
SEL2-17	SEL2-4	Story 4.3: Export Timesheet Report as CSV	Low	2	Backlog	To Do
SEL2-18	SEL2-5	Story 5.1: Timesheet Submission Deadline Reminder	Medium	3	Sprint 2	Done
SEL2-19	SEL2-5	Story 5.2: Approval Status Notification	Medium	3	Sprint 2	Done
SEL2-20	SEL2-5	Story 5.3: Budget Threshold Alert	Low	5	Backlog	To Do

Per-epic totals: Epic 1 = 10 pts, Epic 2 = 21 pts, Epic 3 = 13 pts, Epic 4 = 10 pts, Epic 5 = 11 pts (total 65).

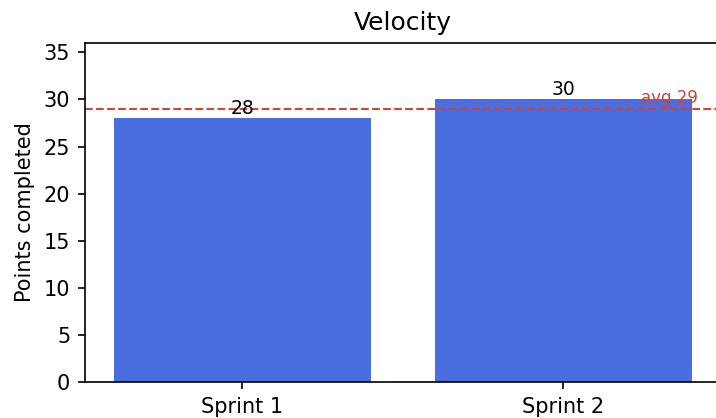
3. Story-point assignment (Planning Poker outcome)

Points	Stories	Rationale
2	SEL2-8, SEL2-17	Small, well-understood CRUD/export work; half-day effort.
3	SEL2-7, 12, 15, 18, 19	Single-screen or rule-based work with a clear acceptance test (e.g. 24-hour daily cap).
5	SEL2-6, 9, 13, 14, 16, 20	Multiple components or a workflow step; moderate integration or UI effort.
8	SEL2-10, SEL2-11	Highest uncertainty: external Jira sync and budget burn calculations that must meet the 500 ms latency NFR.

4. Sprint plan and outcome

Sprint	Goal	Stories	Committed	Completed
SEL2 Sprint 1 (1 week)	Deliver core time logging, Jira linking and the timesheet submission/approval workflow	SEL2-6, 7, 8, 9, 12, 13, 14 (7)	28	28
SEL2 Sprint 2 (1 week)	Deliver budget burn tracking, Jira sync, reporting and notifications	SEL2-10, 11, 15, 16, 18, 19 (6)	30	30

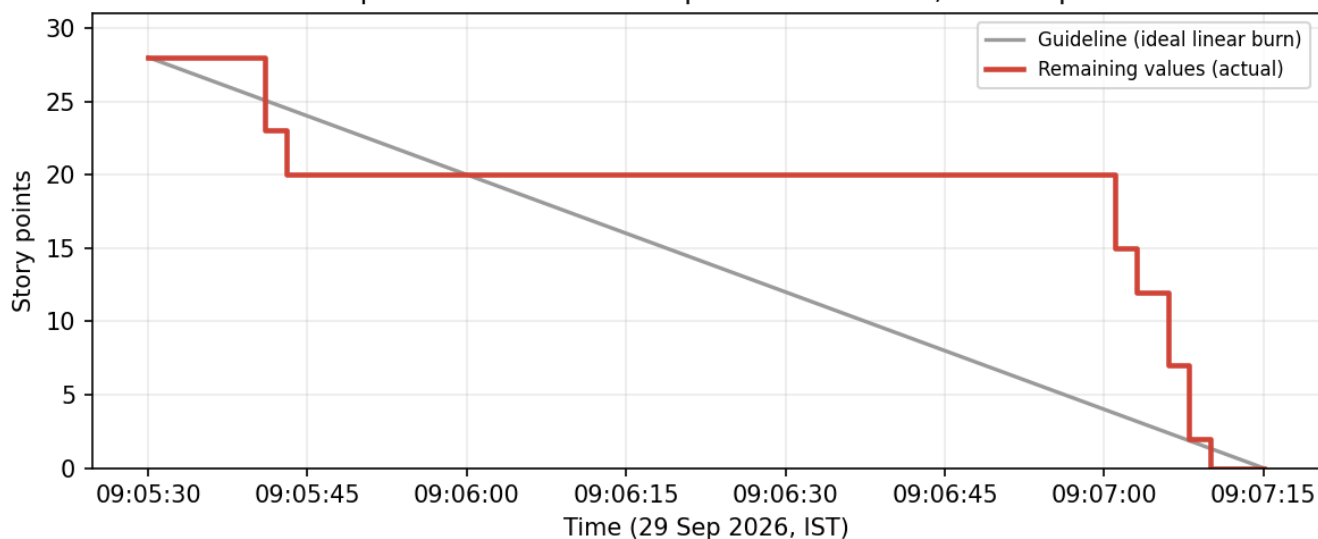
Left in the product backlog for a future sprint (Low priority): SEL2-17 Export Timesheet Report as CSV (2 pts) and SEL2-20 Budget Threshold Alert (5 pts).



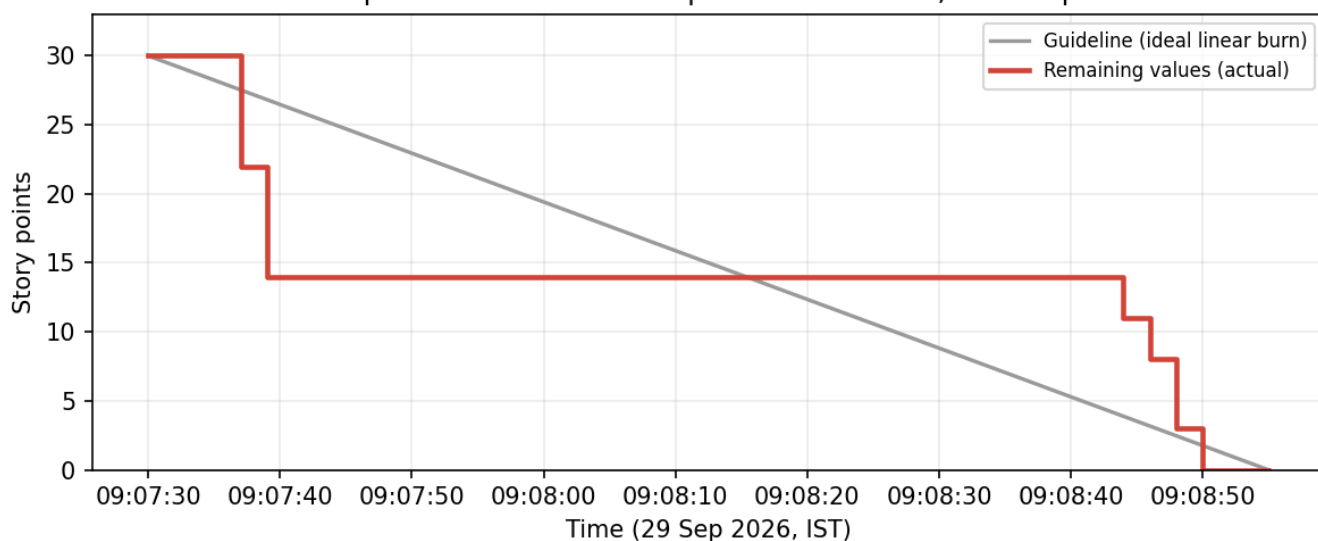
5. Burndown charts

Red line = remaining story points; grey line = ideal linear guideline (same meaning as Jira's Reports > Burndown Chart). Completion times come from each story's Done-transition timestamp in Jira. Because this is a simulated lab, each sprint was worked through within minutes, so the actual curves drop steeply instead of following the guideline.

SEL2 Sprint 1 Burndown – 28 points committed, 28 completed



SEL2 Sprint 2 Burndown – 30 points committed, 30 completed



6. Reflection questions

1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Broadly yes. Both sprints closed with every committed point delivered (28/28 and 30/30), and the 8-point stories (Jira sync and budget burn) were rightly the biggest items. The caveat is that this was a simulation: stories were moved to Done within minutes, so no real effort was measured. The scores are therefore relative judgements, not validated against hours. In a real sprint I would expect the two 8-pointers to overrun first, because they depend on an external Jira API and on the 500 ms dashboard-latency NFR, and I would consider splitting them.

2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Yes. High-priority stories carry the core value chain: log time, block invalid entries, link to Jira, submit, review and approve. They all landed in Sprint 1, giving a usable end-to-end workflow after one week. Medium stories (sync, history, reports, reminders) came next, and the two Low-priority nice-to-haves (CSV export, budget threshold alert) were deferred. One judgement call: Story 2.3 (budget burn, High) sits in Sprint 2 because it depends on the Jira sync work (Story 2.2); depending on how the team ranks manager visibility, it could be argued as a Sprint 1 item.

3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

Closely. Sprint 1 planned 7 stories / 28 points and completed all of them. Sprint 2 planned 6 stories / 30 points and completed all of them. Scope stayed fixed once each sprint started, with no stories added, removed or carried over. Overall 58 of 65 points (89%) were delivered, and the remaining 7 points were deliberately left in the backlog as the lowest-priority work. The alignment is unusually clean because the simulation has no blockers, rework or interruptions.

4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

Velocity was steady at 28 then 30 points, an average of about 29 points per one-week sprint, which is a reasonable planning baseline for the next sprint. The burndown lines fall in sharp steps and finish well ahead of the guideline, which the Jira guidance associates with either under-commitment or work that finished in bursts. Here it mainly reflects the compressed simulation timeline. In a real project I would test the 29-point baseline against actual working days, keep stories to 5 points or fewer where possible, and move stories to In Progress/Done as work happens so the chart shows a smoother, more informative slope.